

The Little Book of Anya

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Chronicles of Slavia

"What do you become when the world breaks?"

Chapter 1. A note before you begin

This is a fan-style compendium of everything currently known about **Anya**, one of the two player characters of *Chronicles of Slavia*. It is written from inside the world — the way a devoted player might compile a character guide — but every fact in it is drawn from the game's actual design canon ([docs/design/*.md](#)), the Zone A game data ([engine/slavia-core/data/zone-a.sgs.toml](#)), the engine source, and the playable prototype ([prototype/zone-a/index.html](#)).

Where the canon is genuinely settled, this book states it as settled. Where the canon is still open — an unanswered question the designers themselves have flagged — this book says so plainly, and collects those questions at the end for whoever picks up the design next. Nothing here is invented lore dressed up as fact.

Chronicles of Slavia is presently a private, exploratory prototype (Level 1, Zone A only — "Border Path"). This book describes a five-percent-built world. Treat everything past Zone A as **design canon for later**, not shipped content — this is called out chapter by chapter.

Chapter 2. Profile at a Glance

Field	Anya
Nationality (in-world)	Ukrainian — Carpathian region
Defined by	Motion — physical, emotional, mental. "Chaos, but chaos with heart."
Her gift (attunement)	Raises taxis — quickens, emboldens, gives confidence, dispels panic. She draws out an animal's vitality.
Native terrain	Forest — stronger aura, more damage resistance, heals over time
Weakening terrain	Tundra — diminished aura, more vulnerable, world grows grey and sluggish around her
Motion verve	1.0 (springy, pronounced, quick — see Motion encodes personality)
Emotional flaw	Avoids stillness, because stillness forces her to face her fears
Hidden strength	Her courage is instinctive — she leaps before she knows she can land, and somehow she does
Costume	Hutsul vyshyvanka — sorochka, keptar, zapaska, namysto, vinok (see What She Wears)
Colours	Red and black cross-stitch, gold accents, coral
Signature abilities	Dash Burst, Impulse Jump, Time Flicker, Chaos Pulse, Momentum Chains
Bond	One of two halves of a single guardian spirit — Anya is its impulse , Donna its structure

Chapter 3. Who She Is

Anya is a Ukrainian girl defined by motion — physical, emotional, mental. She runs toward things, away from things, through things. She is **chaos, but chaos with heart**.

That final clause is the whole point of her. This is not a story about a "wild, reckless" character who exists to be a foil for a "calm, orderly" one. Anya's chaos is explicitly, canonically **transformative** — never destructive for its own sake. The design is direct about this: her courage is instinctive. She leaps before she knows she can land, and somehow she does.

Underneath that instinct sits a flaw the game is honest about: Anya **avoids stillness, because stillness forces her to face her fears**. She keeps moving not because she loves motion for its own sake, but because motion is how she has always outrun whatever she doesn't want to sit with.

Her chaos is not destructive — it is transformative.

— docs/design/09-anya-and-donna-backstories.md

Chapter 4. Before the Rift

Anya grew up in a small town near the **Carpathians** — the mountain range that runs through western Ukraine, home to the Hutsul highland culture whose dress she wears. Her family made things and meant things:

- Her **father repaired old machinery**.
- Her **mother embroidered vyshyvanka patterns** — the traditional Ukrainian cross-stitch that later covers Anya's own clothes.

From them, Anya inherited two things at once: mechanical curiosity, and a symbolic imagination. And also, unmistakably, a restlessness that came from somewhere else entirely. She was always climbing roofs, racing through forests, jumping fences. Teachers called her "too quick." Friends called her "too intense." Anya herself called it "just trying to get somewhere" — and the design is careful to note that she didn't actually know where.

Chapter 5. The Day the World Broke

On the day of the Tear, Anya was doing exactly what she always did when something felt too hard to face: running. Literally — sprinting across a bridge, heart pounding, fleeing a difficult conversation she didn't want to have.

The sky cracked; the embroidery on her shirt glowed; the ground split beneath her. She didn't fall because she tripped — she fell because the Rift reached up and grabbed her. It saw her chaos. It needed her chaos.

— docs/design/09-anya-and-donna-backstories.md

The wording here mirrors Donna's origin exactly, and that symmetry is deliberate. Anya did not stumble into the story by accident. The Rift did not take her because she happened to be nearby. It **saw** the very thing she was running from — the restlessness she'd spent her whole life being told to outgrow — and it **needed** exactly that. Her chaos is not incidental to the plot. It is the reason the plot has her in it at all.

Chapter 6. Her Grammar — What "Stirring" Actually Means

Anya's core gift is not a superpower bolted onto her from outside. In the design's own words, her abilities are **emotional extensions** of who she already was before the Tear — every one of them recognisable as "the girl who runs forward," now made literal.

6.1. Attunement, not command

Animals in Slavia are never tools, pets, buttons, or controllable units — they are living participants, indicators, and sometimes helpers. Anya and Donna do not **command** animals. They **change the rhythm of the world around them**.

Anya tends to excite, quicken, stir, embolden, or agitate natural animals. The animal's own nature determines the result.

— docs/design/03-living-taxis.md

Mechanically, what she moves is called **taxis** — the rate and direction of a living thing's motion and response (the biological sense of the word: an organism's taxis toward or away from a stimulus). **Anya raises the taxis**. She quickens, emboldens, gives confidence, dispels panic — she draws out an animal's **vitality**. The design is explicit that this is **not** aggression or ferocity.

This distinction matters as much for Anya as it does for Donna: her gift works **with** an animal's own nature, drawing out its genuine, best self. It never imposes an alien state. A creature Anya has emboldened is still fully itself — just braver, livelier, more awake. That is categorically different from an enemy who forces **Ferocity** on a creature (imposed rage, against its own nature). Anya lifting a creature's confidence and an enemy making it savage can look similar from a distance; the game treats the difference as a moral line, not a cosmetic one.

There is a hard limit that holds no matter how skilled Anya becomes: **attunement amplifies a thing's nature, it never perverts it**. She can make bees intensely active; she cannot make them "go nuts killing people." That is domination — the enemies' category, never hers.

6.2. An aura, not a button

The gift is described as an **aura** — it emanates from Anya and acts, passively, on what

passes near her, magnified and honed with practice (the canon's own touchstone here is the Nen/Zen aura discipline from *Hunter × Hunter*: something you first leak unbidden, then learn to sense, contain, and direct).

Mastery has two separate axes: **Strength** (how far and how powerfully the aura reaches) and **Control** (how reliably and selectively it acts). Early on, Anya's control is low and leaky — the design's own example puts it best:

Anya walks past the same point [Donna passed without incident] and an animal hops out and becomes part of a moment in the game.

— docs/design/06-attunement-and-modifiers.md

That asymmetry — Anya's mere presence stirring the world, whether she means to or not — is a deliberate feature of the early game. It is what makes her feel like **herself** to play, not just to read about.

6.3. Only Anya can agitate

The taxis duality is not limited to animals — it extends to the world itself.

Only Donna can stabilise; only Anya can agitate. Neither can do the other's act.

— docs/design/06-attunement-and-modifiers.md

The stream bridge in Zone A is the game's first and clearest demonstration of this. Where Donna can still the crossing so it can be walked, Anya's touch does the opposite: she can only set it **bucking and bullwhipping**.

Anya only sets the crossing bucking and bullwhipping — no use for crossing.

— prototype/zone-a/index.html

The design is careful to insist this "useless" half is not actually useless — it is the exact shape of tool that will matter **elsewhere**. An agitated bridge, thrown into motion, could later throw off or bar a pursuer — a possibility recorded (though not yet built) as the "Zone A climax idea: the marauder," where Anya's **destabilising** finally becomes the answer, giving her an active climax to the level that Donna's steadying alone can't provide.

6.4. What the world becomes without her

Together, Anya and Donna hold the world's taxis in balance — one raising, one lowering. Apart, the balance breaks, and the world tips wholesale toward whichever sister remains.

Donna taken (only Anya's raising is left): the world grows over-agitated — turbulent, on edge — and stays that way, harder to move through, until Anya finds her.

— docs/design/06-attunement-and-modifiers.md

This is not flavour text. It is a standing gameplay pressure that persists until the two are reunited — the world itself makes Anya's absence, and Donna's, felt.

Chapter 7. Her Powers, Named

The design is explicit that none of these are magic bolted onto Anya from outside — every one is an extension of the girl who has "always run from things," made literal.

Ability	What it is
Dash Burst	She's always run from things.
Impulse Jump	She leaps before thinking.
Time Flicker	Her mind races faster than the world.
Chaos Pulse	Her emotions destabilize environments.
Momentum Chains	She gets stronger the faster she moves.

Chapter 8. What She Wears

Anya’s costume is culturally grounded — not an aesthetic layered on top of her character, but the visual language of her whole nature. The design specifically calls it "the visual of **energy**": vivid, ornate, alive with motion the moment she takes a step.

8.1. The Hutsul vyshyvanka

The Hutsuls are a highland people of the Ukrainian Carpathians, and their dress is Anya’s entire silhouette:

- **Sorochka** — a white linen chemise, sleeves and chest heavy with geometric cross-stitch dominated by red and black — rhombs, crosses, zig-zags — with gold accents.
- **Keptar** — an embroidered sheepskin vest, tan with red trim.
- **Zapaska** (skirt) — deep red with woven gold stripes and an embroidered hem.
- **Namysto** — strings of red coral beads at the neck.
- **Vinok** — a flower wreath worn by unmarried girls, trailing long ribbons.

8.2. Motion encodes personality

Both girls share a single procedural animation rig; a per-character **verve** value scales how energetically the body reacts to motion. **Anya’s is 1.0** — the maximum. Donna’s, by contrast, is **0.42**.

Reactive element	Anya (high verve)
Body lean	pronounced
Walk bounce	springy
Jump height	springs high
Skirt	flares freely
Hair / ribbons	stream far
Hem sway	lively
Reaction speed	quick

The design’s own framing is worth keeping in mind: this is a schematic, game-scale **evocation** of the embroidery and costume detail, not a literal reproduction — a higher-fidelity portrait pass is explicitly a later art task. What is fixed now is the **behaviour**: Anya’s whole body reads as alive and forward-leaning, before a single word of dialogue is spoken.

Chapter 9. Two Lands, One Heart

Slavia is not just geography. It is memory, medicine, folklore, and moral choice — a world where places remember what happened in them, where every act of courage, care, fear, resentment, trust, or betrayal leaves a mark on the land. Anya and Donna do not simply travel through it. They are read by it, healed by it, tested by it — and eventually, the design intends, they learn to heal it in return.

9.1. Why the Rift chose both of them

The design's deepest answer to "why these two girls" is metaphysical, not coincidental:

Slavia is a world built on balance, and Anya and Donna are two halves of one guardian spirit: Anya — the spirit's impulse. Donna — the spirit's structure. Together — the spirit's harmony.

— docs/design/01-world-principle.md

The Rift did not tear at them because they happened to be nearby. It tore at them **because** they are the one whole thing capable of being split. Their gift — attunement — belongs to them alone, in-world, for exactly this reason: it is not two gifted girls who happen to complement each other, it is one nature, split in two. The guardian spirit itself is glimpsed later in the design (Zone E of the planned five-zone map) and gathered piece by piece before that, through collectible Guardian Spirit Fragments — none of this is built yet.

9.2. How she sees Donna

Anya has always felt misunderstood — too quick, too intense, never quite landing where anyone expected. Donna, the design says plainly, is the first person who doesn't try to slow her down. She doesn't correct Anya's chaos or try to tame it; she tries to **anchor** it, to give it somewhere to land safely. And though Anya rarely admits it out loud, the canon states directly that she trusts Donna more than she lets on.

The two can also **sense each other across the Rift itself** — not merely that the world tilts when one of them is missing, but a direct awareness that survives the barrier between them. This is the mechanical seed for future rescue missions, echo puzzles, and split-path levels: the world can separate their bodies, but never fully their bond.

9.3. What they share, underneath the contrast

Their differences — chaos/impulse/motion against order/logic/stability — are the engine of the game. But underneath the contrast, the design is careful to name what actually makes them the chosen pair:

- **Courage** — both push forward even when afraid.
- **Loyalty** — neither abandons the other; the emotional spine of the story.
- **Curiosity** — both want to understand Slavia, even by opposite routes.
- **Resilience** — they keep going even when the Rift reacts violently.

Chapter 10. Her Side of Slavia

Everything in this chapter is **design canon for later** — none of it is built in the current Zone A prototype, and several items are marked, in the source documents themselves, as still open to the owner's final word. It is included here because it is the clearest picture that exists of where Anya's story is **headed**.

10.1. A possible path

The design's parking-lot notes sketch three tentative class leanings for Anya — **Runner, Flicker, Wildheart** — introduced, in-world, by an apothecary figure who "diagnoses a leaning and offers a path," asking the same question the whole game turns on: *"What do you become when the world breaks?"* No path has been chosen; this is a menu of possibilities, not a commitment.

10.2. Spirits of her heritage

The Ukrainian/Carpathian side of the world's spirit roster (candidate figures, not yet confirmed by the owner) includes the **leshy** (a forest lord), the **rusalka** (a water maiden), the **domovyyk** (a house spirit), and an unnamed fern-flower guardian. Like supernatural animals, a spirit's alignment is never shown as an obvious tell (no glow, no halo) — it is revealed only through behaviour, and the girls default to **innocent until proven guilty**, a naivety the design treats as part of their character, not a gap.

10.3. Flora and healing

If flora affinity follows the same taxis rule as animals — the design's stated intent, though unimplemented — Anya would quicken and open growth rather than still it: bursting buds, sending vines reaching, germinating seeds, setting brambles thrashing. The purest restorative in Slavia, deliberately kept small and fixed rather than built into a sprawling recipe system, is the shared Bulgarian/Ukrainian staple: **yogurt and honey**. A folk-symbol plant tied specifically to her heritage's imagination is the **fern-flower** (*paparać / nanopomь*), a living, ritual, plot-bearing symbol in Slavic folklore.

10.4. What she wears, as she grows

The clothing system's second, still-conceptual layer — **pattern weaving** — would let Anya weave sacred-geometry motifs from the **Berehynia** line (Ukrainian folk-embroidery tradition, named for a protective hearth and water goddess) into her sorochka as she develops. The design is emphatic that these patterns are never a "moveset of triggered special moves" — no cooldowns, no combos. They are passive, ambient, and above all

social: a pattern is a blueprint of who you are, and the world reads it. *"You have THAT pattern? Then of course you are welcome here."*

Chapter 11. Quotes & Moments

Every line below is verbatim from the existing prototype, game data, or the game's own README — nothing paraphrased.

Anya: “I don’t like my chances!”

— `prototype/zone-a/index.html`

Anya only sets the crossing bucking and bullwhipping — no use for crossing.

— `prototype/zone-a/index.html`

Anya crosses what Donna steadied.

— `prototype/zone-a/index.html`

Two lands, one heart.

— `engine/slavia-core/data/zone-a.sgs.toml` — the Shrine beat

For a moment, the world feels whole.

— `engine/slavia-core/data/zone-a.sgs.toml` — the Overlook beat

The Rift awakens. The birds stop answering normally.

— `engine/slavia-core/data/zone-a.sgs.toml` — the Fracture prelude

It saw her chaos. It needed her chaos.

— `docs/design/09-anya-and-donna-backstories.md`

Chapter 12. Fan Corner

Where her design comes from. The design's own touchstones document names *Hunter × Hunter*'s Nen/Zen aura system as the mechanical north star for Anya's (and Donna's) gift — a rigorous, rule-based system that reveals character rather than escalating into raw power, deliberately built **without** the shōnen "everything becomes an ultimate" trap. It also names *Axis Powers Hetalia* as the touchstone for treating Anya as a genuine **personification of a land** — Anya **is** Carpathian Ukraine, the way that show's characters **are** their countries — while explicitly leaving Hetalia's comedy register behind in favour of something "mythic and earnest."

A line worth knowing. The design's one-sentence pitch for the whole game doubles as the tightest possible description of what Anya is **for**:

A folkloric Brothers-meets-Ōkami with a Trine-like switch between two girls — one who stirs, one who stills — and Nen-like systematic depth, set in a Slavic world that reads who you are.

— docs/design/18-touchstones-and-positioning.md

Nickname check. In the earliest playable prototype, Anya's on-screen label when she is the active character simply reads "Anya — she stirs the world" — a line short enough to be a tagline in its own right, and arguably the purest single sentence describing what she does to every scene she enters.

Chapter 13. Open Questions for Further Development

These are drawn directly from what the design canon itself leaves unresolved — not invented gaps, but the actual open questions a next designer, writer, or wiki contributor would need to answer.

13.1. About Anya herself

1. What does Anya actually look like, beyond her costume and hair colour? No age, height, build, eye colour, or skin tone is specified anywhere in the canon.
2. What is Anya's surname, or her family's names? Her father (the machinist) and mother (the embroiderer) are described only by role, never named.
3. What was the "difficult conversation" Anya was fleeing on the day of the Tear — who was it with, and what was it about? The design deliberately leaves this undramatized.
4. How does Anya actually **talk**? Only one line of dialogue exists for her in the whole corpus ("I don't like my chances!"). Is she quick and clipped, wry, prone to running her sentences the way she runs everywhere else?
5. How did Anya and Donna first meet — before the Rift, or only after?

13.2. About her powers and path

1. Which of her three sketched class paths — Runner, Flicker, or Wildheart — is she meant to lean toward, or is the choice left entirely to the player?
2. The imported (non-canon, flagged "to refine") material sketches an arc where Anya's Verve scales exponentially until it becomes a hazard to **herself**, risking dissolving into "dust" unless she learns self-discipline and internal serenity — is that tension something the finished story explores, or was it a discarded idea?
3. Does Anya ever learn to sit still with what she's avoiding — the flaw the design explicitly names for her — and if so, in which Chronicle?

13.3. About her world

1. Which of the candidate Ukrainian/Carpathian spirits (leshy, rusalka, domovyk, the fern-flower guardian) are confirmed canon, and do any of them appear in Chronicle I specifically, or only later?
2. Do plants have will of their own, the way supernatural animals do, or only the rare

supernatural ones?

3. Is Chronicle I's tone meant to be calm and folkloric (as Zone A currently plays) or "surreal, dangerous, fast-paced" (as an earlier structure document describes it)? The design itself flags this as unresolved.
4. Is the eventual game switch-only between the two girls, or genuinely co-operative/simultaneous? Both are recorded in different documents as live possibilities.

This compendium reflects the design canon of Chronicles of Slavia as of the date it was compiled. It is not an official design document — treat it as a fan’s-eye map of what is known, built to make the next step easier to take.